



MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

WHY HAS PEACE PROVED SO ELUSIVE IN THE MIDDLE EAST?

Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945-1995 - Key

Topic 1: The birth of the state of Israel, 1945-63

Scholar:

Class:

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT 1.0: Foundational Geography & Geopolitics: Why the Middle East Ignited			
L2: KT 1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949			
L3: KT 1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War & The Palestinian Refugee Crisis			
L4: KT 1.3: Increased Tension, Nasser, and the Suez Crisis, 1955–1963			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT 1.0: Foundational Geography & Geopolitics: Why the Middle East Ignited

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyse how the Sykes-Picot Agreement (1916) and League of Nations mandates drew artificial straight lines across former Ottoman territories.
- ☐ Evaluate the contradictory British wartime pledges: the McMahon-Hussein Correspondence (1915) versus the Balfour Declaration (1917).
- ☐ Identify the 4 strategic flashpoints of the Arab-Israeli conflict: Maritime Chokepoints, Elevated High Ground, Freshwater Basins, and Jerusalem.

Q1. Why did British and French diplomats believe drawing straight lines across tribal, ethnic, and religious lands would remain stable, and why did this arbitrary imperial partition create over a century of chronic conflict?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which three continents intersect at the Middle East, making it a critical strategic crossroads throughout world history?

What vital maritime waterway, completed in 1869 across Egypt, connects the Mediterranean Sea directly to the Red Sea?

What narrow body of water at the southern tip of the Sinai Peninsula controls maritime access to the Gulf of Aqaba and Israel's southern port of Eilat?

Which elevated volcanic plateau in south-western Syria directly overlooks the Sea of Galilee and northern Israeli civilian settlements?

Which freshwater river forms the natural eastern boundary of the West Bank, flowing south from the Sea of Galilee into the Dead Sea?

Which ancient city is considered a sacred holy sanctuary by Jews, Christians, and Muslims, and claimed as a capital by both Israelis and Palestinians?

Which vast triangular desert peninsula connecting Africa to Asia served as a major military buffer zone between Egypt and Israel?

What secret agreement in May 1916 saw British and French diplomats use a ruler to carve the collapsing Ottoman Empire into European spheres of influence?

What official British letter in November 1917 promised British support for the establishment of a "national home for the Jewish people" in Palestine?

Why is military control of "high ground" like the Golan Heights considered an indispensable defense asset in modern warfare?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least *FOUR* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Sykes-Picot Agreement Mandate Balfour Declaration Zionism Arab Nationalism Chokepoint Contested Territory
--

Q2. Explain why the Sykes-Picot Agreement and League of Nations mandates created artificial borders in the Middle East.

Q3. Source Detective: Study the 1916 Sykes-Picot Agreement map above. What does the straight pencil line drawn between the British and French zones reveal about European imperial priorities versus on-the-ground ethnic and religious realities?

Q4. Source Detective: Study the 1917 Balfour Declaration letter (Source B). How did Britain's commitment to a "national home for the Jewish people" directly contradict the wartime promises of Arab sovereignty made to Sharif Hussein in the McMahon-Hussein Correspondence?

Q5 Diplomatic Contradictions Matrix: Complete the comparative planner analyzing the three conflicting British wartime pledges during World War One:

Wartime Agreement	Date & Key Signatories	Recipient & British Commitment	Why It Contradicted Other Pledges

Q6. Explain the fundamental contradiction between the McMahon-Hussein Correspondence and the Balfour Declaration.

Q7 Strategic Flashpoints & Chokepoints: Match each critical geographic flashpoint on the left with its decisive military significance on the right:

1. The Straits of Tiran (Gulf of Aqaba)	• •	Israel's only southern maritime corridor for oil imports; its blockade by Egypt in 1956 and 1967 constituted an immediate act of war.
2. The Golan Heights (South-western Syria)	• •	Elevated volcanic plateau giving Syrian artillery commanding sightlines to bombard civilian Israeli settlements across the Galilee plain.
3. The Suez Canal (Egypt)	• •	Vital 120-mile maritime artery connecting the Mediterranean to the Red Sea, cutting 5,000 miles off trade routes between Europe and Asia.
4. The River Jordan & West Bank Ridge	• •	Natural freshwater boundary and strategic mountain ridge providing essential defensive depth against ground invasion from the east.

Q8. Why were the Golan Heights and the Straits of Tiran of supreme strategic importance in the Arab-Israeli wars?

Map Task 1: The Geopolitical Landscape of the Middle East

Understanding the physical and political geography of the Middle East is the indispensable foundation for understanding its modern conflicts. The borders of the modern Middle East were largely carved out by British and French imperial diplomats following the collapse of the Ottoman Empire after World War One. Control over vital maritime chokepoints—such as the Suez Canal, the Straits of Tiran, and the Persian Gulf—alongside access to scarce freshwater sources like the River Jordan, repeatedly triggered diplomatic showdowns and full-scale wars between 1948 and 1973.

Using the blank outline map provided in your workbook (and the reference map in your textbook), accurately locate and label the 9 key nation-states, 8 capital cities, and 8 critical maritime waterways/chokepoints that shaped 20th-century Middle Eastern history.

PUPIL TASK CHECKLIST:

 Countries (9):

- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Israel
- ☐ Jordan
- ☐ Syria
- ☐ Lebanon
- ☐ Iraq
- ☐ Iran
- ☐ Saudi Arabia
- ☐ Turkey

 Capitals (8):

- ☐ Cairo
- ☐ Jerusalem
- ☐ Tel Aviv
- ☐ Amman
- ☐ Damascus
- ☐ Beirut
- ☐ Baghdad
- ☐ Riyadh

 Waterways & Chokepoints (8):

- ☐ Suez Canal
- ☐ Straits of Tiran
- ☐ Gulf of Aqaba
- ☐ Gulf of Suez
- ☐ Red Sea
- ☐ River Jordan
- ☐ Mediterranean Sea
- ☐ Persian Gulf
- ☒ Sinai Peninsula



Map Task 2: Israel & The Contested Territories (Post-1967)

Using the regional outline map of Israel and its immediate frontiers, complete the following geographical and historical tasks to examine the territorial transformations of the 1948 and 1967 wars.

PUPIL TASK CHECKLIST:

4 Immediate Neighbours:

- ☐ Lebanon (North)
- ☐ Syria (Northeast)
- ☐ Jordan (East)
- ☐ Egypt (Sinai Peninsula, Southwest)

Strategic Water Bodies:

- ☐ Mediterranean Sea
- ☐ Sea of Galilee
- ☐ River Jordan
- ☐ Dead Sea
- ☐ Gulf of Aqaba

Occupied Territories (June 1967): (Shade with diagonal lines /// and label)

- ☐ West Bank (captured from Jordan – shade ///)
- ☐ Gaza Strip (captured from Egypt – shade ///)
- ☐ Golan Heights (captured from Syria – shade ///)
- ☐ Sinai Peninsula (vast desert buffer captured from Egypt)
- ☐ Jerusalem ★ (Mark with a star on the 1949 Green Line)



GCSE Exam Practice

Q9. Explain one consequence of the Balfour Declaration (1917) for Arab-Jewish relations in Palestine.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 3-STEP PEE FORMULA (POINT, EVIDENCE, EXPLANATION)

EDEXCEL PAPER 2

Write exactly 1 focused analytical paragraph (approx. 5 minutes). Do NOT write an introduction, conclusion, or a second consequence.

[P] Point (Consequence): State ONE clear, valid consequence of the Balfour Declaration (1917) directly addressing Arab-Jewish relations in Palestine.

[E] Evidence (Contextual Detail): Deploy precise historical facts (names, dates, treaties, or figures) from 1917–1939 to prove what happened.

[E] Explanation (Causal Impact): Explain the lasting causal effect on Arab-Jewish relations or regional geopolitics using causal connectives.

Sentence Starters:

- "One consequence of the Balfour Declaration (1917) was the entrenchment of intense, long-term political and communal hostility between Arab Palestinians and Jewish immigrants under the British Mandate."
- "For example, following the declaration, Jewish immigration expanded rapidly during the 1920s and 1930s, accompanied by land purchases by the Jewish National Fund that displaced tenant farmers (fellahin)."
- "As a direct result of this British imperial endorsement, Arab Palestinians felt betrayed and disenfranchised, which consequently triggered widespread intercommunal violence including the 1929 Western Wall Riots and the 1936–39 Arab Revolt."

Causal Connectives: As a direct result • Consequently • This led directly to • Because of this • This meant that • Crucially

EXIT TICKET: THE GEOPOLITICAL PRIORITY VERDICT

EXIT TICKET • EVALUATIVE RANKING LADDER

Which foundational factor studied today created the greatest long-term obstacle to peace in the Middle East? Rank them from 1 (Most Destabilising) to 3 (Least Destabilising) and justify your #1 rank:

- Factor A: Contradictory Imperial Pledges (McMahon-Hussein Correspondence vs Balfour Declaration vs Sykes-Picot).
- Factor B: Artificial Borders & Mandates (European straight-line borders dividing historic ethnic and religious communities).
- Factor C: Strategic Chokepoints & Topography (vulnerability around the Straits of Tiran, Golan Heights, and Suez Canal).

Teacher Guidance: State your #1 factor and write 2-3 structured sentences using precise historical vocabulary (e.g., mandate, sovereignty, buffer zone, casus belli) to justify your choice.

Pupil Response:

L2: KT 1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- ☐ Analyze the key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- ☐ Describe the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

Q1. Source Detective: Why did the Irgun target the British administrative and military headquarters at the King David Hotel, and how did this attack convince the British government that maintaining the Mandate was untenable?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which secret 1916 agreement between Britain and France partitioned the Middle East into European spheres of influence?

What official British declaration in November 1917 supported the establishment of a Jewish national home in Palestine?

What international body granted Britain the official Mandate to govern Palestine in 1920?

What was the political movement founded by Theodor Herzl aiming to create a sovereign Jewish homeland?

Why was the Suez Canal of supreme imperial importance to Great Britain?

What narrow maritime strait at the mouth of the Gulf of Aqaba links Israel's port of Eilat to the Red Sea?

Which elevated plateau overlooking Galilee was a major source of border clashes between Syria and Israel?

Which three world religions consider the Old City of Jerusalem sacred?

What freshwater river forms the natural boundary between the West Bank and Jordan?

What vast desert peninsula connects Africa to Asia and borders southern Palestine?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Mandate Zionism Irgun Nakba
--

Your Sentence:

Q2. What was the 'dual obligation' that Britain faced under the League of Nations Mandate of Palestine?

Q3. Identify two reasons why Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin set a strict immigration quota of 1,500 Jewish immigrants per month.

Q4 Chronological Causal Sequence: Order the following 5 key developments leading to the British decision to abandon Palestine from 1 (Earliest) to 5 (Latest):

- ☐ Ernest Bevin imposes a strict monthly quota of 1,500 Jewish immigrants to appease oil-rich Arab allies.
- ☐ The Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi form the United Resistance Movement to launch coordinated sabotage against British military infrastructure.
- ☐ The Irgun detonates explosives in the King David Hotel, destroying the British Mandate headquarters and killing 91 people.
- ☐ The Royal Navy boards the SS Exodus and forcibly returns 4,500 Holocaust survivors to displaced persons camps in Europe.

☐ Faced with public outrage over the 'Sergeants Affair' and a £100m annual policing cost, Britain hands Palestine to the United Nations.

Q5. What was the 'Jewish Insurgency' and which three Zionist groups united to launch it?

Q6. Describe the deadliest act of the insurgency on 22 July 1946 and explain its intended target.

Q7. Source Detective: Study Source B. Why did the execution and public display of the two British sergeants create such overwhelming political pressure on Clement Attlee's government to surrender the Mandate?

Q8. How did the British public react to the 'Sergeants Affair', and what was the political result?

Q9. Source Detective: How did Britain's decision to forcibly deport Holocaust survivors back to displaced persons camps in Europe destroy British diplomatic standing in the United States?

Q10 UN Resolution 181 Partition Matrix: Complete the comparative table below analyzing the territorial allocations and reactions to the 1947 UN Partition Plan:

Dimension	Proposed Jewish State	Proposed Arab State	City of Jerusalem (Corpus Separatum)

Q11. How did the United Nations Partition Plan (Resolution 181) divide the land of Palestine, and what was the reaction of the two communities?

Q12. What was the impact of the Deir Yassin massacre on the Palestinian Arab population in April 1948?

Q13. Source Detective: Why did Ben-Gurion choose to declare independence beneath the portrait of Theodor Herzl on the exact afternoon British forces withdrew?

Q14. Describe the tactical advantage Israel gained during the first UN truce in June 1948.

Q15. Explain the conflicting historical views regarding the displacement of over 700,000 Palestinians during the 1948 war.



WRITTEN CONSOLIDATION & RECALL

Recall & Analysis

Q16. Explain two reasons why the British government decided to hand the Palestine Mandate to the United Nations in 1947.

Guidance: Consider the financial and military exhaustion of Britain after World War Two, and the escalating guerrilla attacks by Zionist underground groups (Irgun and Lehi) such as the King David Hotel bombing.

SENTENCE STARTERS:

- Firstly, Britain was financially and militarily exhausted after World War Two, meaning...
- Secondly, Britain could no longer control escalating violence and attacks, such as...

Pupil Response:

Historian's Corner: The Debate over Plan Dalet

Historians sharply disagree on the nature of Plan D. Traditional Israeli historians argue it was a purely defensive necessity to secure besieged Jewish settlements before the Arab armies invaded. However, 'New Historians' like Ilan Pappé argue the text of Plan D proves it was a deliberate blueprint for the systematic ethnic cleansing of Palestinian Arabs from the future Jewish state.

Q17. How does Pappé's interpretation of Plan Dalet fundamentally change our understanding of the Palestinian refugee crisis?

GCSE Exam Practice

Q18. Explain one consequence of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946) for British policy in Mandatory Palestine.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 3-STEP PEE FORMULA (POINT, EVIDENCE, EXPLANATION)	EDEXCEL PAPER 2
<i>Write exactly 1 focused analytical paragraph (approx. 5 minutes). Do NOT write an introduction, conclusion, or a second consequence.</i> [P] Point (Consequence): State ONE clear, valid consequence of the bombing of the King David Hotel (July 1946) directly addressing British policy in Mandatory Palestine. [E] Evidence (Contextual Detail): Deploy precise historical facts (names, dates, treaties, or figures) from 1946–1947 to prove what happened. [E] Explanation (Causal Impact): Explain the lasting causal effect on Arab-Jewish relations or regional geopolitics using causal connectives. Sentence Starters: • <i>"One consequence of the Irgun's bombing of the King David Hotel in July 1946 was the collapse of British domestic and political willpower to maintain military control over Mandatory Palestine."</i> • <i>"For example, the attack killed 91 British military officers, civil servants, and Arab and Jewish staff, destroying the central administrative secretariat of the British Mandate."</i> • <i>"As a direct result of the escalating military casualties, immense financial costs (spending £40 million annually during post-war austerity), and public outrage in London, the British government consequently announced in February 1947 that it was surrendering the Mandate to the United Nations."</i> Causal Connectives: As a direct result • Consequently • This led directly to • Because of this • This meant that • Crucially	

EXIT TICKET: THE THREE-TIERED GOLDEN SENTENCE

EXIT TICKET · THE GOLDEN SENTENCE

Write **ONE single, grammatically sophisticated historical sentence** explaining why Great Britain decided to abandon its Mandate of Palestine in 1947. Your sentence **MUST** strictly contain all three required ingredients:

- Ingredient 1 (Date / Stat): Include one precise date or statistic [e.g., July 1946, 91 deaths, £100 million mandate cost, or Resolution 181].
- Ingredient 2 (Individual / Group): Name one key historical individual or group [e.g., Ernest Bevin, the Irgun, Menachem Begin, or UNSCOP].
- Ingredient 3 (Causal Conjunction): Connect your cause and effect using an analytical conjunction [e.g., consequently, provoked by, culminating in, or whereas].

Teacher Guidance: Ensure your sentence clearly shows cause and effect, not just a list of facts.

Pupil Response:

L3: KT 1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War & The Palestinian Refugee Crisis

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the territorial changes and their impact, including the refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- ☐ Understand the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and the Law of Return (1950), and the importance of US aid to Israel.
- ☐ Analyze Israel's relations with Egypt in the aftermath of the war.

Q1. How does this photograph demonstrate the human scale and trauma of the Palestinian refugee crisis (the Nakba) that followed the 1948–49 War?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which international organisation was given responsibility for deciding the future of Palestine in 1947?

What was the number of the UN Partition Plan passed on 29 November 1947 dividing Palestine?

What percentage of Mandatory Palestine was allocated to the proposed Jewish state under Resolution 181?

What status was proposed for the city of Jerusalem under the 1947 UN Partition Plan?

How did Arab leaders and the Arab Higher Committee respond to UN Resolution 181?

On what date did David Ben-Gurion officially proclaim the declaration of the State of Israel?

What occurred on the day immediately following Israel's declaration of independence?

What was the Jewish paramilitary force that formed the foundation of the newly created Israeli Defence Forces (IDF)?

What Jewish militant group bombed the British headquarters at the King David Hotel in July 1946?

Which European superpower provided crucial initial diplomatic recognition and permitted Czech arms shipments to Israel in 1948?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Green Line**

Q2. Source Detective: How did the newly formed IDF successfully counter five invading Arab armies despite being heavily outnumbered in early 1948?

Q3 Territorial Transformation Matrix: Complete the table comparing the 1947 UN Partition Plan boundaries with the actual 1949 Armistice (Green Line) outcomes:

Territory / Region	Allocated Under UN 181 (1947)	Actual Outcome Under 1949 Armistice	Controlling Authority after 1949

Q4. What happened to the remaining portions of mandate Palestine (the West Bank and Gaza Strip) following the 1948-49 war?

Q5. Source Detective: Study the possessions and families fleeing in the photograph. What does this reveal about the suddenness of their flight and the immense humanitarian crisis created across the region?

Q6. How did the United Nations attempt to cope with the vast humanitarian emergency created by the displacement of 700,000 Palestinian Arabs?

Q7 The Refugee Deadlock Matrix: Complete the table analyzing the opposing policies and rationales regarding the displaced Palestinian refugees:

Key Actor	Official Policy on Palestinian Refugees	Strategic & Political Rationale

Q8. Why did both Israel and the Arab host states refuse to permanently integrate the Palestinian refugees into their societies?

Q9. Source Detective: Compare the 1949 Green Line with the 1947 UN Partition Plan: which areas did Israel capture beyond its original UN allocation?

Q10. Why was the establishment of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) in May 1948 highly significant for Israel's internal politics and national security?

Q11. Explain the demographic impact of the 1950 Law of Return on the new State of Israel.

Q12. Why did President Harry S. Truman authorise massive emergency loans and grants to Israel in its early years?

Q13. Source Detective: Locate the Straits of Tiran at the southern tip of the Sinai Peninsula. Why was Egypt's naval blockade here considered an act of war (casus belli) by Israel?

Q14. Describe two ways that Egypt attempted to strangle Israel economically and militarily in the early 1950s.

Q15. How did David Ben-Gurion attempt to deter Fedayeen border raids, and what was the consequence?

Q16. Explain how cross-border Fedayeen raids and Israeli reprisal strikes increased border tensions between 1950 and 1955.



WRITTEN CONSOLIDATION & RECALL

Recall & Analysis

Q17. Explain two reasons why the Israeli Defence Forces were able to defeat the Arab armies in the 1948–49 War.

Guidance: Focus on Arab disunity and rivalries between Arab leaders compared to Israel's unified military command, high motivation, and secret influx of modern Czechoslovakian arms.

SENTENCE STARTERS:

- One reason for Israel's victory was superior organisation and supplies, such as...
- Another crucial factor was Arab disunity and competing political goals, because...

Pupil Response:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q18. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War. You may use the following in your answer: • The United Nations truce (June 1948) • The 1949 Armistice Agreements (The Green Line) You must also use information of your own.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

**EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 3-STAGE CHRONOLOGICAL LINKAGE CHAIN
(BEGINNING → MIDDLE → END)**

EDXCEL
PAPER 2

Write exactly 3 logically connected chronological paragraphs (approx. 10–12 minutes). You **MUST** use both stimulus points **PLUS** at least one development from your own knowledge. Show **HOW** each event directly triggered the next.

[1] The Beginning (Catalyst & Origin): Explain how the declaration of Israel and the Arab invasion on 15 May 1948 initiated the conflict (Stimulus: Outbreak of war).

[2] The Middle (Causal Turning Point): Explain the decisive turning point: the first UN truce (June 1948) allowing Israeli rearmament with Czech arms, Plan Dalet, and the displacement of Palestinian civilians (Own Knowledge).

[3] The End (Culmination & Resolution): Explain the culmination: Israeli military victories across the Negev and Galilee, the 1949 Armistice Agreements (Green Line), and UN Resolution 194 (Stimulus: 1949 military armistice).

Sentence Starters:

- "The 1948–49 War was initiated when David Ben-Gurion proclaimed the independence of the State of Israel on 14 May 1948, prompting five neighbouring Arab states to launch an immediate invasion."
- "A decisive turning point occurred during the first UN ceasefire in June 1948, when the IDF secretly rearmed with heavy Czechoslovakian weaponry and launched offensive operations (such as Operation Dani), which directly caused the mass displacement of over 700,000 Palestinian Arabs (the Nakba)."
- "This situation culminated in early 1949 with the signing of bilateral armistice agreements on Rhodes, which established the de facto 'Green Line' borders, leaving Israel in control of 78% of Mandatory Palestine while the refugee crisis remained entirely unresolved."

Causal Connectives: The crisis was initiated when • This directly triggered • A decisive turning point occurred when • Consequently • As a direct consequence • This situation culminated in

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Stimulus Point 1

The United Nations truce (June 1948)

Stimulus Point 2

The 1949 Armistice Agreements (The Green Line)

EXIT TICKET: SPOT THE HISTORICAL IMPOSTER

EXIT TICKET · TWO TRUTHS & ONE FALLACY

Below are three statements regarding the 1948–49 War and the refugee crisis. **Two are historically accurate facts; one is an IMPOSTER containing a classic GCSE examiner misconception.**

- Statement A: The 1949 Armistice Agreements (Green Line) left Israel in control of 78% of mandatory Palestine, significantly expanding beyond the 56% proposed in the 1947 UN Partition Plan.
- Statement B: The United Nations deployed an international military peacekeeping army in May 1948 that successfully enforced the borders of an independent Palestinian Arab state in the West Bank.
- Statement C: Under the 1950 Law of Return, every Jewish person worldwide was granted the automatic right to settle in Israel and gain citizenship, doubling Israel's population within four years.

Teacher Guidance: Task: State which statement is the imposter (A, B, or C) and write the 1-sentence historical correction explaining what actually happened.

Pupil Response:

L4: KT 1.3: Increased Tension, Nasser, and the Suez Crisis, 1955–1963

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- ☐ Analyze the events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- ☐ Evaluate the events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

Q1. Why did the Anglo-French military intervention at Suez backfire so disastrously on the international stage?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What term do Palestinians use to describe the catastrophe of their expulsion and displacement in 1948?

Approximately how many Palestinian Arabs became refugees during the 1948–49 War?

What was the name of the de facto armistice boundary line drawn on maps in 1949?

Which neighboring Arab kingdom annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem following the 1948 War?

Which Arab nation retained administrative military control over the Gaza Strip after 1949?

What legislation passed by Israel in 1950 granted every Jewish person worldwide the legal right to immigrate to Israel?

What was the unified national army established by David Ben-Gurion in 1948?

Which global superpower provided extensive financial loans and diplomatic backing to Israel in the early 1950s?

What was the decisive 4-week turning point in June 1948 that allowed Israel to rearm with Czech weapons?

Who served as Israel's first Prime Minister from 1948 to 1953?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Pan-Arabism Czech Arms Deal Nationalisation Protocol of Sèvres UNEF
--

Driven by the ideology of [.], sought to modernize Egypt. Following the [.], the West refused to fund his dam project. In retaliation, Nasser announced the [.] of the Suez Canal. This led to the secret [.] where Israel, Britain, and France invaded Egypt. The conflict ended with the deployment of [.] peacekeepers in the Sinai.

Q2. Source Detective: Study the portrait of Nasser. Why did his charismatic leadership and anti-colonial stance inspire such widespread devotion across the Arab world?

Q3. What were Gamal Abdel Nasser's immediate political and domestic objectives after taking power in Egypt?

Q4. Why did Israel launch a devastating reprisal raid on the Gaza Strip on 28 February 1955, and what was the result?

Q5. What was the significance of the 1955 Czech Arms Deal for the balance of power in the Middle East?

Q6. Source Detective: How did Nasser use the revenue of the canal to fund the construction of the Aswan High Dam after Western loans were cancelled?

Q7. How did President Nasser respond when the United States and Great Britain abruptly withdrew their funding for the Aswan High Dam?

Q8 Protocol of Sèvres Collusion Matrix: Complete the table below analyzing the secret conspiracy forged between Britain, France, and Israel in October 1956:

Conspiring Nation	Key National Motive / Grievance	Agreed Secret Role in Operation Kadesh

Q9. What was the secret Protocol of Sèvres in October 1956?

Q10. Source Detective: Study the troop movements on the map. How did the rapid Israeli capture of the Mitla Pass and Sinai allow Britain and France to claim they were merely intervening as "peacekeepers" to protect the Suez Canal?

Q11. Explain how Britain and France planned to use an Israeli invasion of the Sinai as a pretext to retake the Suez Canal.

Q12. Source Detective: Why did Britain and France claim they were entering Egypt as neutral peacekeepers to separate Israeli and Egyptian armies when the Sèvres Protocol proved they had pre-planned the war together?

Q13. Why did the Anglo-French-Israeli conspiracy backfire and end in a humiliating retreat?

Q14. Identify two vital security guarantees Israel received in exchange for withdrawing its forces from the Sinai Peninsula.

Q15. Explain why Nasser's nationalisation of the Suez Canal led Britain, France, and Israel to collude against Egypt.



WRITTEN CONSOLIDATION & RECALL

Recall & Analysis

Q16. Explain why the Suez Canal was of vital strategic and economic importance to Britain and France in 1956.

Guidance: Consider Western Europe's heavy economic dependence on Middle Eastern oil shipped through the canal, and Britain's need to maintain a maritime highway to its remaining empire in Asia.

SENTENCE STARTERS:

- Economically, Britain and France relied heavily on the Suez Canal because...
- Strategically, losing control of the waterway to President Nasser threatened them because...

Pupil Response:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q17. Explain the importance of the Suez Crisis (1956) for British and French imperial influence in the Middle East.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 'X LINKED TO Y' SIGNIFICANCE FRAMEWORK (2 FOCUSED PEEL PARAGRAPHS)

EDExcel
PAPER 2

Write exactly 2 analytical PEEL paragraphs (approx. 10–12 minutes). Divide your analysis into (1) Immediate / Short-Term Importance and (2) Long-Term / Strategic Significance. Always explain the difference the nationalisation of the Suez Canal (1956) made for international relations in the Middle East.

[P1] Immediate / Short-Term Importance: Explain how Nasser's nationalisation immediately challenged Anglo-French imperial prestige and provoked the secret Protocol of Sèvres invasion with Israel.

[P2] Long-Term / Strategic Transformation: Explain how the American financial intervention and Soviet missile threats permanently ended European imperial hegemony and established the Middle East as a Cold War proxy battleground.

Sentence Starters:

- *"In the short term, Nasser's nationalisation of the Suez Canal on 26 July 1956 was of decisive importance because it triggered a secret tripartite military conspiracy that brought the region to the brink of global war."*
- *"This was demonstrated when Britain, France, and Israel secretly signed the Protocol of Sèvres in October 1956 to launch a coordinated invasion to seize the canal and overthrow Nasser."*
- *"In the long term, the crisis fundamentally transformed Middle Eastern international relations by definitively ending British and French imperial dominance and establishing the region as a bipolar Cold War proxy battleground between the USA and the Soviet Union."*

Causal Connectives: In the short term, the nationalisation of the Suez Canal (1956) was of decisive importance for international relations in the Middle East because • This was demonstrated when • In the long term, this fundamentally altered • Crucially, the strategic impact was that • Ultimately, the significance of the nationalisation of the Suez Canal (1956) for international relations in the Middle East was that

EXIT TICKET: THE CAUSAL BALANCE SCALE

EXIT TICKET • THE CAUSAL BALANCE SCALE

Weigh the historical outcome of the 1956 Suez Crisis on a scale of 0 to 10 for Egypt and Gamal Abdel Nasser:

- [0] A Catastrophic Military Defeat: Israel crushed the Egyptian army in Sinai; Britain and France occupied Port Said.
- [5] A Stalemate: Egypt lost military assets, but forced an imperial withdrawal.
- [10] An Historic Political Triumph: Nasser humiliated Britain and France, kept the canal, and became the undisputed leader of the Arab world.

Teacher Guidance: Task: Where on the scale (0 to 10) do you place the outcome for Nasser, and what is your *SINGLE* decisive piece of historical evidence from today's lesson justifying your score?

Pupil Response:

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East (1945–1995)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)

GCSE Exam Practice: Question Bank

Choose an exam question from the bank below and answer it on the blank lined pages that follow.

From KT 1.0: Foundational Geography & Geopolitics: Why the Middle East Ignited

Q. Complete the geopolitical map of the Middle East by checking off each feature as you label it: - 🌐 Major Countries: Egypt, Israel, Jordan, Syria, Lebanon, Iraq, Iran, Saudi Arabia, Turkey - 🏛️ Capital Cities: Cairo, Jerusalem, Tel Aviv, Amman, Damascus, Beirut, Baghdad, Riyadh - 🌊 Waterways & Chokepoints: Suez Canal, Straits of Tiran, Gulf of Aqaba, Gulf of Suez, Red Sea, River Jordan, Mediterranean Sea, Persian Gulf - 🏞️ Key Peninsula: Sinai Peninsula

1. Explain one consequence of the Balfour Declaration (1917) for Arab-Jewish relations in Palestine.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

From KT 1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

1. Explain one consequence of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946) for British policy in Mandatory Palestine.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

From KT 1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War & The Palestinian Refugee Crisis

1. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War. You may use the following in your answer: • The United Nations truce (June 1948) • The 1949 Armistice Agreements (The Green Line) **You must also use information of your own.**

[8 marks • 10 mins]

From KT 1.3: Increased Tension, Nasser, and the Suez Crisis, 1955–1963

1. Explain the importance of the Suez Crisis (1956) for British and French imperial influence in the Middle East.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

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This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

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